

Q For organisations that aren't yet using the cloud, what's the first step?

Cloud computing and the adoption of cloud services enable organisations to drive innovation and optimisation, to reduce risk and costs, and to gain greater enterprise agility. With cloud computing, organisations can consume shared compute and storage resources rather than building and maintaining their own infrastructure. The former option allows businesses to focus on their core operations.

It is important for organisations taking their first steps towards cloud computing to develop a customised cloud strategy. They should plan to leverage existing collateral with software-as-a-service (SaaS), infrastructure-as-a-service (IaaS) and platform-as-a-service (PaaS) strategies, as well as review applicable deployment models - private, public or hybrid. Organisations should also research the possibilities of establishing cloud gateways so that their users need not worry about data security and public access with an easy-to-use hybrid environment.

Q What is the difference between backup and cloud sync products?

Cloud syncing and computer backups are two very different features of the cloud. A backup service is a point-in-time state of your data. With backup you can copy files on a schedule, and only capture the changes made since the previous copy saved.

A cloud sync, on the other hand, synchronises your data to the cloud, e.g., your photos, videos, songs, emails, contacts and documents, as per the time interval that's specified. Sync generally saves the modifications and new updates on the content.

Cloud sync keeps two copies of your most recent changes at all times—one locally (the file you're working with) and the other at another location, for backup or remote retrieval. Cloud sync may not allow you to see how your data was a week back or a month back, but backups can be scheduled as per your needs.

Q What are your thoughts on the current trend of creating cloud storage products for businesses?

Data is growing exponentially and most organisations are failing to meet this growing demand. It is difficult to estimate the storage required for a given span of time, for an organisation. Over provisioning wastes their resources and decreases the ROI, while under provisioning creates problems and management overheads, which leads to losses.

We, at ESDS Software Solution Pvt Ltd, are working on offering storage-as-a-service to end users on a pay-per-use model. One can put any volume of data on to cloud storage and pay based on the volume, without worrying about the ROI. We are thinking along the lines of a managed storage service model, which could measurably deliver a uniform level of service maintained under a specialised network infrastructure, while assuring our users that their data is in safe hands. For us, storage is not a product, but a continual service.

“Cloud computing is probably the most cost effective way to use, maintain and upgrade IT infrastructure. Traditional desktop software and hardware cost companies a lot of money. The licensing fees for multiple users can prove to be very expensive for an establishment. But in the case of the cloud, this is available at much cheaper rates and, hence, can significantly lower the company's IT expenses.”

Q What does the future hold for cloud storage?

A key point in cloud storage is the amount of bandwidth available to upload data. When users turn on Cloud Storage Sync, all their local data is synced on the cloud and is accessible to them anytime, anywhere.

Due to the simplicity and accessibility of cloud storage, its consumption is going to grow from a few MBs per user to many GBs. This is also going to impact telecom business owners, as they will need to make more and more of the bandwidth available for quick user access. As cloud storage gets more popular, the market will become more competitive, driving the cost of storage down.

Q Given the dynamic world of both cloud computing and the technologies surrounding the platform, organisations have to be extra careful with their data. So what would you recommend organisations ought to do, going forward? What can they do to better protect their data?

This is the time for all organisations to act upon cloud security initiatives by putting in place the right infrastructure, applications and access policies. Security at both the data and network layers should be well handled by designing the right network access and data protection policies.

Q Cloud computing is basically the dynamic delivery of information over the Internet. What do organisations need to really understand about this?

Cloud computing is becoming an increasingly popular enterprise model as it delivers computing resources to users as and when needed. The cloud offers an elastic environment to scalable applications as it allows for rapid resource allocation during times of high demand, as well as resource de-allocation as demand declines. Organisations should choose the right vendor with a good reputation for offering scalable and dynamic cloud services on a secure environment.